Then rinse the soap off the skin with the wash cloth, and dry well with the towel. Back rub lotion or spirit is then rubbed into harden the patients skin. Talcum powder is applied to leave the skin dry and smooth.

It is usual to treat first the back and hips and then if necessary the elbows, knees and ankles. Leave the bed tidy and the patient comfortable.

If the patient is incontinent, it is better to use ointment such as zinc, castor oil instead of spirit and powder, to protect the skin from moisture.

2.6 HAIR WASH

Purpose

1. To keep the hair clean and healthy
2. To prevent itching, infection, infestation
3. To provide a sense of well being
4. To destroy pediculi

Articles Required:

1. Jugs with hot and cold water
2. Two buckets
3. A basin and mug
4. A blanket to cover the patient
5. Two towels
6. Shampoo, crushed soap nut or soap
7. Wash cloth to cover the eyes
8. A little cotton to put into the ears
9. Kidney tray and paper bag
10. Comb and oil
11. Hot water bag in cold season to dry the hair

Procedure:

1. Explain the procedure to the patient, and screen the bed
2. Bring the articles to the bed side
3. Move the patient near the edge of the bed.
4. Protect the patients shoulders with a small rubber sheet and a towel and pin it in front
5. Fold and place the wash cloth over the eyes and put cotton in the ears
6. Loosen the hair and comb out tangles
7. Mix the hot and cold water and test the temperature
8. Wet the hair with warm water. Apply shampoo or soap, and rub the scalp and hair well.
9. Rinse the hair well. Squeeze the water from the hair.
10. Remove the bucket of dirty water, and collect the rubber sheets into the second bucket.
11. Place a clean towel under the patients head and dry the hair well
12. Make the patient comfortable. The hot water bottle may be placed underneath the towel on which the hair is spread to dry
13. When dry, comb the hair and braid it.
14. Remove all articles, clean and replace them chart the procedure.

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